

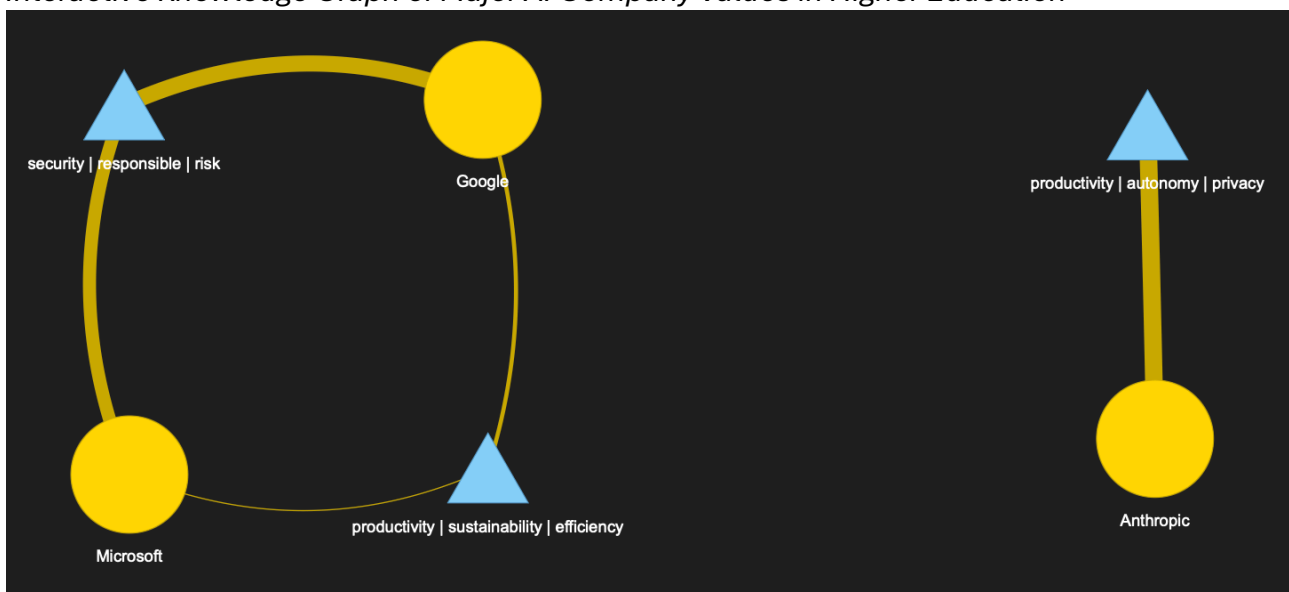
The search for narratives was conducted online and comprised visionary, administrative, and practical strategic communications, ranging from formal white papers and press releases to reports, technical guides, blog posts, and discussions. To ensure data symmetry, a comparable corpus of discursive artifacts was established for each company, allowing for a balanced cross-sectional analysis of their sociotechnical imaginaries

The documents were divided in a three-level hierarchy consisting of AI generally, AI in education, and AI in higher education. This approach ensured the finding of distinct imaginaries at each level.

Amongst the values of the companies found during topic modelling were productivity, sustainability, efficiency, security, autonomy, and privacy.

Figure 1

Interactive Knowledge Graph of Major AI Company Values in Higher Education



Note. Google and Microsoft both link to the two clusters named security | responsible | risk (14 and 12 documents, respectively) and productivity | sustainability | efficiency (6 and 4 documents, respectively) while Anthropic links to the cluster named productivity | autonomy | privacy (15 documents). The cluster names stem from each topic's three highest-scoring words during topic modelling – to let the focus be on significant values underpinning the company communications, stop words include brand names and other generic terms, e.g. specific words in technology and statistics.

The topic modelling successfully isolated three distinct value-constellations. Google and Microsoft primarily inhabit a managerial imaginary defined by security | responsible | risk and productivity | sustainability | efficiency, positioning the platform as a trusted institutional guardian. In contrast, Anthropic occupies a more individualistic imaginary, linking to productivity | autonomy | privacy. This indicates that while 'productivity' remains a shared corporate value across all actors, it is bifurcated between an institutional logic of efficiency and an individual logic of autonomy.

Mapping these clusters onto van Dijck's (2018) platform society framework reveals a clear division of labour. Connectors (Google and Microsoft) utilize an institutional imaginary of security and sustainability to cement their role as the indispensable infrastructure of the university. Conversely, Anthropic acts as a complementor, utilizing a humanistic imaginary of autonomy and privacy to define its niche within the student-AI relationship. While both actors share the neoliberal value of productivity, they bifurcate its meaning: one as a tool for institutional optimization, the other as a tool for cognitive agency.